“Śrī Caitanya-caritāmṛta”

Ādi-līlā

Chapter 16

A Brief Description of the Youthful Pastimes

(English translation from the Bengali, following the Gauḍīya Maṭha edition and the Anubhāṣya, 2026)

Amṛta-pravāha-bhāṣya

Summary. The sixteenth chapter describes Mahāprabhu’s pastimes in His youth (*kaiśora*): He teaches, defeats the paṇḍitas, sports in the waters of the Jāhnavī, travels to Vaṅga (East Bengal) to gather funds, holds learned debates there and leads *nāma-saṅkīrtana*, meets Tapana Miśra, instructs him about *sādhya* and *sādhana*, and orders him to go to Vārāṇasī. While Mahāprabhu was conquering Vaṅga, Lakṣmī-devī, on the pretext of a snakebite, departed for Vaikuṇṭha. The Lord returned home and consoled Śacīdevī with knowledge of the truth (*tattva-jñāna*). Then He married Viṣṇupriyā. He spoke with the *digvijayī* (conqueror of all directions) Keśava Kāśmīrī, examined his verse on the glory of the Gaṅgā, showed in it five poetic ornaments and excellences and five faults, and crushed his pride. That night the *digvijayī* poet learned from Sarasvatī who the Lord truly is, and the next morning he surrendered to Him.

Gaurahari, ever intent on mercy —

কৃপাসুধা-সরিদ্ যস্য বিশ্বমাপ্লাবয়ন্ত্যপি ।
নীচগৈব সদা ভাতি তং চৈতন্যপ্রভুং ভজে ॥ ১ ॥

kṛpā-sudhā-sarid yasya
of mercy nectar the river whose
viśvam āplāvayanty api
the universe flooding although
nīca-gaiva sadā bhāti
flowing downward always shines
taṁ caitanya-prabhuṁ bhaje
that Caitanya Prabhu I worship

1 I worship Caitanya Prabhu. The river of His nectarean mercy floods the whole universe, and yet, like every river, it always flows downward — to the lowly.[1]

Amṛta-pravāha-bhāṣya.
The river of the nectar of His mercy floods the whole world, yet it always appears to flow downward (*nīca-gā*). I worship that Lord Caitanya.

Anubhāṣya.
yasya (Caitanyadeva's) **kṛpā-sudhā-sarit** (river of the nectar of mercy) **viśvam** (the world, *saṁsāra*) **āplāvayantī** (submerging) **api**, **sadā nīca-gā** (flowing downward, that is, full of compassion for the humble, who have neither wealth nor anything of their own) **bhāti** (is manifest), **taṁ caitanya-prabhum** (I) **bhaje**.

জয় জয় শ্রীচৈতন্য জয় নিত্যানন্দ ।
জয়াদ্বৈতচন্দ্র জয় গৌরভক্তবৃন্দ ॥ ২ ॥

jaya jaya śrī-caitanya jaya nityānanda
glory glory to Śrī Caitanya glory to Nityānanda
jayādvaitacandra jaya gaura-bhakta-vṛnda
glory to Advaitacandra glory of Gaura the devotees to the multitude

2 Glory, glory to Śrī Caitanya! Glory to Nityānanda! Glory to Advaitacandra! Glory to all the devotees of Gaura!

Gaurahari, worshipped by Lakṣmī and Sarasvatī —

জীয়াৎ কৈশোর-চৈতন্যো মূর্ত্তিমত্যা গৃহাশ্রমাৎ ।
লক্ষ্ম্যার্চ্চিতোঽথ বাগ্দেব্যা দিশাংজয়ি-জয়চ্ছলাৎ ॥ ৩ ॥

jīyāt kaiśora-caitanyo
may He be victorious in His youth Caitanya
mūrti-matyā gṛhāśramāt
embodied on entering household life
lakṣmyārcito 'tha vāg-devyā
by Lakṣmī worshipped then by the goddess of speech
diśāṁ jayi-jaya-cchalāt
of the directions of the conqueror of the conquest under the pretext

3 Glory to Caitanya in His youth! When He entered household life, Lakṣmī herself served Him in visible form; and then Sarasvatī, the goddess of speech, worshipped Him as well, taking His victory over the conqueror of all directions as her occasion.

Amṛta-pravāha-bhāṣya.
All glory to the youthful Caitanyadeva! Lakṣmī-devī in person, who had come to His home, worshipped Him, and the goddess of speech worshipped Him on the pretext of the *digvijayī*'s defeat.

Anubhāṣya.
gṛhāśramāt (having entered household life, the *gṛhastha-āśrama*) **mūrti-matyā** (embodied) **lakṣmyā arcitaḥ** (served), **atha diśāṁ jayi-jaya-cchalāt** (on the pretext of the victory over the *digvijayī*, the scholar named Keśava Kāśmīrī) **vāg-devyā** (by Sarasvatī) **arcitaḥ** (honoured) **kaiśora-caitanyaḥ** (Caitanya at the age of *kiśora*) **jīyāt**.

*The pastimes of youth (*kaiśora*) —*

এই ত' কৈশোর-লীলা-সূত্র-অনুবন্ধ ।
শিষ্যগণ পড়াইতে করিলা আরম্ভ ॥ ৪ ॥

ei ta' kaiśora-līlā-sūtra-anubandha
thus of youth of the pastimes of the outline the sequence
śiṣya-gaṇa paḍāite karilā ārambha
the students to teach He made beginning

4 Here, in outline, are the pastimes of His youth. He began to teach students of His own.

Anubhāṣya.

***Kaiśora*.** The age from eleven to fifteen years is called *kiśora*; *kaiśora* means what belongs to that age.

Nimāi's teaching amazes everyone —

শত শত শিষ্য সঙ্গে সদা অধ্যাপন ।
ব্যাখ্যা শুনি' সর্ব্বলোকের চমকিত মন ॥ ৫ ॥

śata śata śiṣya saṅge sadā adhyāpana
hundreds hundreds students with always teaching
vyākhyā śuni' sarva-lokera camakita mana
the explanations hearing of all people astonished minds

5 He taught constantly, with hundreds of students around Him, and all who heard His explanations were amazed.

The paṇḍitas are pleased even when defeated by Nimāi —

সর্ব্বশাস্ত্রে সর্ব্ব পণ্ডিত পায় পরাজয় ।
বিনয়ভঙ্গীতে কারো দুঃখ নাহি হয় ॥ ৬ ॥

sarva-śāstre sarva paṇḍita pāya parājaya
in all the śāstras all paṇḍitas meet defeat
vinaya-bhaṅgīte kāro duḥkha nāhi haya
by His courteous manner anyone's pain not arises

6 In every branch of learning every paṇḍita met defeat at His hands, yet His manner was so courteous that no one was hurt.

Amṛta-pravāha-bhāṣya.

The Lord defeated the paṇḍitas in every *śāstra*, but His humility was so skilful that the paṇḍitas were not hurt.

বিবিধ ঔদ্ধত্য করে শিষ্যগণ-সঙ্গে ।
জাহ্নবীতে জলকেলি করে নানা রঙ্গে ॥ ৭ ॥

vividha auddhatya kare śiṣya-gaṇa-saṅge
various pranks He plays the students with
jāhnavīte jala-keli kare nānā raṅge
in the Jāhnavī water sports He has with many delights

7 With His students He played all kinds of pranks, and they sported merrily in the waters of the Gaṅgā.

*The journey to East Bengal and the launching of *nāma-saṅkīrtana* —*

কতদিনে কৈল প্রভু বঙ্গেতে গমন ।
যাঁহা যায়, তাঁহা লওয়ায় নাম-সংকীর্ত্তন ॥ ৮ ॥

kata dine kaila prabhu baṅgete gamana
after some days made the Lord to Baṅga journey
yāṁhā yāya, tāṁhā laoyāya nāma-saṁkīrtana
wherever He went, there He made them take up of the holy name the chanting

8 After some time the Lord went to East Bengal, and wherever He went He had the people take up the chanting of the holy name.

Hearing of the Lord's fame for learning, many students come to study —

বিদ্যার প্রভাব দেখি' চমৎকার চিত্তে ।
শত শত পড়ুয়া আসি' লাগিলা পড়িতে ॥ ৯ ॥

vidyāra prabhāva dekhi' camatkāra citte
of learning the power seeing wonder in heart
śata śata paḍuyā āsi' lāgilā paḍite
hundreds hundreds students coming began to study

9 Seeing the power of His learning, hundreds of students came in wonder to study with Him.

*Tapana Miśra meets the Lord and asks about the truth of *sādhya* and*

sādhana —

সেই দেশে বিপ্র, নাম — মিশ্র তপন ।
নিশ্চয় করিতে নারে সাধ্য-সাধন ॥ ১০ ॥

sei deśe vipra, nāma — miśra tapana
in that land a brāhmaṇa, named — Miśra Tapana
niścaya karite nāre sādhya-sādhana
to settle could not the goal and the means

10 In that land lived a brāhmaṇa named Tapana Miśra, who could not settle what the goal of life is and how it is reached.

Amṛta-pravāha-bhāṣya.

***Sādhya* and *sādhana*.** What one attains through *sādhana* is called *sādhya*, the goal. The means by which one attains the goal is called *sādhana*.

*The many views of many sages in many *śāstras* bewilder the mind —*

বহুশাস্ত্রে বহুবাক্যে চিত্তে ভ্রম হয় ।
সাধ্য-সাধন-শ্রেষ্ঠ না হয় নিশ্চয় ॥ ১১ ॥

bahu-śāstre bahu-vākye citte bhrama haya
in many scriptures in many statements in mind confusion arises
sādhya-sādhana-śreṣṭha nā haya niścaya
the goal and the means best not is certain

11 Many scriptures and many opinions had confused his mind, and he could not decide which goal is highest and which means is best.

Anubhāṣya.

(*Śrīmad-Bhāgavatam* 7.13.8): "…He should not study many books… he should not live by expounding [the scriptures]…" That is, one should not master many books and arts, nor make a living by expounding the *śāstras*. Whoever seeks the highest good (whoever wishes to serve the Lord) must first give up this temptation. (*Bhakti-rasāmṛta-sindhu*, Pūrva, second wave.)

(*Śrīmad-Bhāgavatam* 11.21.30, 36): "People whose minds are bewildered by such flowery speech, who are proud and very greedy, find no taste even in talk about Me. The Veda in sound is very hard to understand; it is manifest in the vital

air, the senses and the mind; it is boundless, deep and unfathomable, like the ocean."

This means the following. The merchants of the *śāstras*, who support the *karma-kāṇḍa* and the *jñāna-kāṇḍa*, speak words honey-sweet and flowery (charming), yet hostile to selfless devotion to the Lord, full of envy and aimed at enjoying fruits. Hearing or reading such words, inexperienced and fickle people of weak faith cannot grasp the supreme greatness and beauty of devotion to Kṛṣṇa and love for Kṛṣṇa, the jīva's eternal *sādhana* and eternal *sādhya*. Turned away [from the Lord] since time without beginning, they very easily submit to the *karmīs* and *jñānīs*, and lose the mercy of the pure devotee of Kṛṣṇa, the jīva's well-wisher, who is free from envy. So, lacking the pious merit (*sukṛti*) that turns one towards bhakti, they are flung far from pure bhakti, the only path to eternal good, and at last reach endless misfortune and the utmost misery. When Śrī Gaurasundara in Vārāṇasī expounded the truth of *sādhya* and *sādhana* in answer to the questions of Śrī Sanātana Gosvāmī Prabhu, Tapana Miśra was present there. He heard the Lord and found the answer to his doubts. For the good of ignorant jīvas who follow many *śāstras* and many gurus, Mahāprabhu taught a lesson through the example of His devotee Tapana Miśra (by resolving his doubts).

In a dream a brāhmaṇa advises him to ask Nimāi Paṇḍita about the truth —

স্বপ্নে এক বিপ্র কহে, — শুনহ তপন ।
নিমাঞিপণ্ডিত-স্থানে করহ গমন ॥ ১২ ॥

svapne eka vipra kahe, — śunaha tapana
in a dream a brāhmaṇa says — listen, Tapana
nimāñi-paṇḍita-sthāne karaha gamana
of Nimāi Paṇḍita to the place make going

12 In a dream a brāhmaṇa said to him, "Listen, Tapana. Go to Nimāi Paṇḍita.

তিঁহো তোমার সাধ্য-সাধন করিবে নিশ্চয় ।
সাক্ষাৎ ঈশ্বর তিঁহো, — নাহিক সংশয় ॥ ১৩ ॥

tiṁho tomāra sādhya-sādhana karibe niścaya
He your goal and means will make certain
sākṣāt īśvara tiṁho, — nāhika saṁśaya
directly the Lord He is — there is no doubt

13 He will settle for you the goal and the means. He is the Lord Himself — have no doubt of it."

Amṛta-pravāha-bhāṣya.
The *śāstras* are many, and what each of them defines as *sādhya* and as *sādhana* turns out to differ. Whoever sets out to read many *śāstras* cannot decide which *sādhya* is best and which *sādhana* is best, and his mind falls into confusion. Tapana Miśra's mind was confused in just this way, and so in a dream he was told to go to Nimāi Paṇḍita and become certain of *sādhya* and *sādhana* from Him. In the dream Miśra was also told: "Have no doubt: Nimāi Paṇḍita is the Lord (Īśvara) Himself."

He tells the Lord about his dream —

স্বপ্ন দেখি' মিশ্র আসি' প্রভুর চরণে ।
স্বপ্নের বৃত্তান্ত সব কৈল নিবেদনে ॥ ১৪ ॥

svapna dekhi' miśra āsi' prabhura caraṇe
the dream seeing Miśra coming of the Lord at the feet
svapnera vṛttānta saba kaila nivedane
of the dream the account all made submission

14 After this dream Miśra came to the Lord's feet and told Him all that he had dreamt.

*The Lord proclaims Hari's holy name to be both *sādhya* and *sādhana* —*

প্রভু তুষ্ট হঞা সাধ্য-সাধন কহিল ।
নাম-সংকীর্ত্তন কর, — উপদেশ কৈল ॥ ১৫ ॥

prabhu tuṣṭa hañā sādhya-sādhana kahila
the Lord pleased becoming the goal and the means told
nāma-saṁkīrtana kara, — upadeśa kaila
of the holy name the chanting do — instruction gave

15 Pleased with him, the Lord explained the goal and the means, and instructed him: "Chant the holy name."

Amṛta-pravāha-bhāṣya.

The Lord said: "Neither knowledge of Brahman as undifferentiated oneness nor enjoyment (*bhukti*) in heaven and other worlds is the goal (*sādhya*) of the jīva. The jīva's only goal is love for Kṛṣṇa. *Karma* and jñāna are not the *sādhana*, the means of attaining that goal. The only means of attaining it is pure bhakti that takes shelter of Kṛṣṇa's name."

The Lord orders him to go to Kāśī —

তাঁর ইচ্ছা, — প্রভুসঙ্গে নবদ্বীপে বসি ।
প্রভু আজ্ঞা দিল, — তুমি যাহ বারাণসী ॥ ১৬ ॥

tāṁra icchā, — prabhu-saṅge navadvīpe vasi
his wish — with the Lord in Navadvīpa to live
prabhu ājñā dila, — tumi yāha vārāṇasī
the Lord order gave — you go to Vārāṇasī

16 He wished to live with the Lord in Navadvīpa, but the Lord told him, "Go to Vārāṇasī.

তাঁহা আমা-সঙ্গে তোমার হবে দরশন ।
আজ্ঞা পাঞা মিশ্র কৈল কাশীতে গমন ॥ ১৭ ॥

tāṁhā āmā-saṅge tomāra habe daraśana
there with Me your will be meeting
ājñā pāñā miśra kaila kāśīte gamana
the order receiving Miśra made to Kāśī going

17 There we shall meet again." Receiving this order, Miśra went to Kāśī.

The good fortune to come: serving the Lord in Kāśī, and hearing from the Lord's own lips, in answer to Śrī Sanātana's questions, the full resolution of the

*truth of *sādhya* and *sādhana* —*

প্রভুর অনন্ত লীলা বুঝিতে না পারি ।
স্বসঙ্গ ছাড়াঞা কেন পাঠান কাশীপুরী ॥ ১৮ ॥

prabhura ananta līlā bujhite nā pāri
of the Lord endless pastimes to understand not I can
sva-saṅga chāḍāñā kena pāṭhāna kāśīpurī
from His own company sending away why He sends to Kāśī

18 The Lord's pastimes are endless and beyond my understanding. Why did He send Miśra away from His company to Kāśī?

Good for all the people of East Bengal —

এই মত বঙ্গের লোকের কৈল সবার হিত ।
'নাম' দিয়া ভক্ত কৈল, পড়াঞা পণ্ডিত ॥ ১৯ ॥

ei mata baṅgera lokera kaila sabāra hita
in this way of Baṅga to the people did to all good
'nāma' diyā bhakta kaila, paḍāñā paṇḍita
the name giving devotees He made, teaching paṇḍitas

19 In this way the Lord did good to all the people of East Bengal: giving them the holy name He made them devotees, and teaching them He made them paṇḍitas.

Amṛta-pravāha-bhāṣya.

"Giving the name": that is, by giving Kṛṣṇa's name — "Hare Kṛṣṇa Hare Kṛṣṇa Kṛṣṇa Kṛṣṇa Hare Hare / Hare Rāma Hare Rāma Rāma Rāma Hare Hare" — the Lord made the people of Vaṅga devotees, and by teaching them the *śāstras* He made many of them paṇḍitas.

এই মত বঙ্গে প্রভু করে নানা লীলা ।
এথা নবদ্বীপে লক্ষ্মী বিরহে দুঃখী হৈলা ॥ ২০ ॥

ei mata baṅge prabhu kare nānā līlā
in this way in Baṅga the Lord enjoys various pastimes
ethā navadvīpe lakṣmī virahe duḥkhī hailā
here in Navadvīpa Lakṣmī in separation sorrowful became

20 While the Lord enjoyed these many pastimes in East Bengal, here in Navadvīpa Lakṣmī grieved in separation from Him.

Bitten by the black snake of separation from the Lord, Lakṣmī departs from the manifest pastimes —

প্রভুর বিরহ-সর্প লক্ষ্মীরে দংশিল ।
বিরহ-সর্প-বিষে তাঁর পরলোক হৈল ॥ ২১ ॥

prabhura viraha-sarpa lakṣmīre daṁśila
of the Lord the snake of separation Lakṣmī bit
viraha-sarpa-viṣe tāṁra paraloka haila
of the snake of separation by the poison her passing to the other world came about

21 The snake of separation from the Lord bit Lakṣmī, and by its poison she passed from this world.

Amṛta-pravāha-bhāṣya.
The pain of separation from the Lord took the form of a snake and bit Lakṣmī. Then she went to the "other world" (*para-loka*), that is, to her own abode Vaikuṇṭha, the best of all worlds.

The Lord, who knows all hearts, returns home —

অন্তরে জানিলা প্রভু, যাতে অন্তর্য্যামী ।
দেশেরে আইলা প্রভু শচী-দুঃখ জানি' ॥ ২২ ॥

antare jānilā prabhu, yāte antaryāmī
within knew the Lord, since the Indweller
deśere āilā prabhu śacī-duḥkha jāni'
to His homeland came the Lord of Śacī the grief knowing

22 Dwelling in every heart, the Lord knew of it; and, aware of Śacī's grief, He returned home.

Hearing the knowledge of truth from the Lord's lips, Śacī finds her grief eased —

ঘরে আইলা প্রভু বহু লঞা ধন-জন ।
তত্ত্ব কহি' কৈল শচীর দুঃখ-বিমোচন ॥ ২৩ ॥

ghare āilā prabhu bahu lañā dhana-jana
home came the Lord much bringing wealth and people
tattva kahi' kaila śacīra duḥkha-vimocana
the truth speaking made of Śacī of grief the removal

23 He came home with much wealth and many followers, and by speaking of the truth He freed Śacī from her grief.

Amṛta-pravāha-bhāṣya.
"Telling the truth": another reading has "with the net of truth." The Lord cast a net of knowledge of the truth — "'Who is whose husband, whose son…,' that is, who is anyone's husband, who anyone's son, who anyone's wife" — and freed Śacī from her grief.

The Lord delights in learning —

শিষ্যগণ লঞা পুনঃ বিদ্যার বিলাস ।
বিদ্যা-বলে সবা জিনি' ঔদ্ধত্য প্রকাশ ॥ ২৪ ॥

śiṣya-gaṇa lañā punaḥ vidyāra vilāsa
the students gathering again of learning the play
vidyā-bale sabā jini' auddhatya prakāśa
by the power of learning all conquering pride displaying

24 Again He gathered His students and delighted in the play of learning; by the power of His knowledge He conquered everyone and showed a proud spirit.

Marriage to Śrī Viṣṇupriyā, daughter of the royal paṇḍita Sanātana, and the defeat of Keśava Kāśmīrī —

তবে বিষ্ণুপ্রিয়া-ঠাকুরাণীর পরিণয় ।
তবে ত' করিল প্রভু দিগ্বিজয়ী জয় ॥ ২৫ ॥

tabe viṣṇupriyā-ṭhākurāṇīra pariṇaya
then of Viṣṇupriyā Ṭhākurāṇī the marriage
tabe ta' karila prabhu digvijayī jaya
then indeed made the Lord over the conqueror of the directions victory

25 Then came His marriage to Viṣṇupriyā Ṭhākurāṇī, and after that the Lord's victory over the *digvijayī*, the conqueror of all directions.

Amṛta-pravāha-bhāṣya.

The *digvijayī* was a paṇḍita from Kashmir named Keśava Miśra. After being taught by Mahāprabhu he became an ācārya in the sampradāya of Śrī Nimbāditya and wrote a gloss (*ṭippanī*) on the commentaries Nimbāditya composed, the *Vedānta-pārijāta* and others.

Anubhāṣya.

The *digvijayī* was a paṇḍita from Kashmir named Keśava. At that time he was travelling through various parts of Bhāratavarṣa, intent on conquering the paṇḍitas by his genius, and at last he came to Gauḍa-deśa, to Navadvīpa. After his defeat by Śrī Gaurasundara he came to know who Śrīman Mahāprabhu truly is, and in order to serve the Lord he entered the Nimbārka sampradāya. He wrote a gloss (*ṭippanī*) called *Kaustubha-prabhā* on the *Vedānta-kaustubha*, Śrīnivāsācārya's commentary on the *Pārijāta-bhāṣya* that Nimbārka composed on the *Vedānta-darśana*. The *Bhakti-ratnākara*, in its twelfth wave, says: "The disciplic succession of Nimbāditya: 1. Śrīnivāsācārya, 2. Viśvācārya, 3. Puruṣottama, 4. Vilāsa, 5. Svarūpa, 6. Mādhava, 7. Balabhadra, 8. Padma, 9. Śyāma, 10. Gopāla, 11. Kṛpā, 12. Devācārya, 13. Sundara Bhaṭṭa, 14. Padmanābha, 15. Upendra, 16. Rāmacandra, 17. Vāmana, 18. Kṛṣṇa, 19. Padmākara, 20. Śravaṇa, 21. Bhūri, 22. Mādhava, 23. Śyāma, 24. Gopāla, 25. Balabhadra, 26. Gopīnātha, 27. Keśava, 28. Gokula, 29. Keśava Kāśmīrī." And again in the *Bhakti-ratnākara*: "He chanted the mantra of the goddess Sarasvatī; all learning was revealed to him, and his power grew. Having conquered all directions, he became famous as the '*digvijayī*.' He was from Kashmir, a most cultured

brāhmaṇa. Giving up everything, he departed by the Lord's order. Having described *līlā-bhoga* (?), under the name 'Laghu-Keśava.'"[7] See the *Vaiṣṇava-mañjuṣā* (issue 1).

Honour to Ṭhākura Vṛndāvana dāsa —

বৃন্দাবনদাস ইহা করিয়াছেন বিস্তার ।
স্ফুট নাহি করে দোষ-গুণের বিচার ॥ ২৬ ॥

vṛndāvanadāsa ihā kariyāchena vistāra
Vṛndāvana-dāsa this has made elaboration
sphuṭa nāhi kare doṣa-guṇera vicāra
clearly not makes of faults and merits analysis

26 Vṛndāvana dāsa has described all this at length, but he did not set out clearly the merits and faults of the *digvijayī*'s verse.

Examining the merits and faults of Keśava Kāśmīrī's verse —

সেই অংশ কহি, তাঁরে করি' নমস্কার ।
যা শুনি' দিগ্বিজয়ী কৈল আপনা ধিক্কার ॥ ২৭ ॥

sei aṁśa kahi, tāṁre kari' namaskāra
that part I tell, to him making obeisance
yā śuni' digvijayī kaila āpanā dhik-kāra
which hearing the *digvijayī* made of himself reproach

27 Bowing to him, I shall tell of that analysis; hearing it, the *digvijayī* cursed himself.

*How the *digvijayī* was defeated. The *digvijayī* arrives —*

জ্যোৎস্নাবতী রাত্রি, প্রভু শিষ্যগণ সঙ্গে ।
বসিয়াছেন গঙ্গাতীরে বিদ্যার প্রসঙ্গে ॥ ২৮ ॥

jyotsnāvatī rātri, prabhu śiṣya-gaṇa saṅge
moonlit night, the Lord the students with
vasiyāchena gaṅgātīre vidyāra prasaṅge
was sitting on the bank of the Gaṅgā in discussion of learning

28 One moonlit night the Lord sat with His students on the bank of the Gaṅgā, discussing points of learning.

হেনকালে দিগ্বিজয়ী তাঁহাই আইলা ।
গঙ্গারে বন্দন করি' প্রভুরে মিলিলা ॥ ২৯ ॥

hena-kāle digvijayī tāṁhāi āilā
at that time the *digvijayī* just there came
gaṅgāre vandana kari' prabhure mililā
to the Gaṅgā homage having made the Lord he met

29 Just then the *digvijayī* came there and, after offering his prayers to the Gaṅgā, met the Lord.

*The Lord honours others (*mānada-dharma*) —*

বসাইল তারে প্রভু আদর করিয়া ।
দিগ্বিজয়ী কহে মনে অবজ্ঞা করিয়া ॥ ৩০ ॥

vasāila tāre prabhu ādara kariyā
seated him the Lord respect showing
digvijayī kahe mane avajñā kariyā
the *digvijayī* speaks in his mind disdain holding

30 The Lord received him with respect and gave him a seat, but the *digvijayī* spoke with disdain in his heart:

*Out of pride the *digvijayī* shows contempt for the Lord —*

ব্যাকরণ পড়াহ, নিমাঞি পণ্ডিত — তোমার নাম ।
বাল্যশাস্ত্রে লোকে তোমার কহে গুণগ্রাম ॥ ৩১ ॥

vyākaraṇa paḍāha, nimāñi paṇḍita — tomāra nāma
grammar You teach, Nimāi Paṇḍita — Your name
bālya-śāstre loke tomāra kahe guṇa-grāma
in the children's science people Your speak of merits

31 "You teach grammar, and Your name is Nimāi Paṇḍita. People praise Your skill in the science that children learn.

Anubhāṣya.
Bālya-śāstra means grammar, because the accepted rule is to study grammar for a knowledge of the language before studying any other *śāstra*.

ব্যাকরণ-মধ্যে, জানি, পড়াহ কলাপ ।
শুনিলুঁ ফাঁকিতে তোমার শিষ্যের সংলাপ ॥ ৩২ ॥

vyākaraṇa-madhye, jāni, paḍāha kalāpa
among grammars, I know, You teach the Kalāpa
śuniluṁ phāṁkite tomāra śiṣyera saṁlāpa
I have heard on the tricky points Your students' discussions

32 Of the grammars, I know, You teach the *Kalāpa*, and I have heard of Your students' debates on its tricky points."

Amṛta-pravāha-bhāṣya.
"You teach the grammar called *Kalāpa*. And I have heard that your students hold discussions (*saṁlāpa*), that is, special conversations, about the *phāṅki* of grammar, that is, about intricate questions."

The Lord's humble words and His request to praise the Gaṅgā —

প্রভু কহে, ব্যাকরণ পড়াই — অভিমান করি ।
শিষ্যেতে না বুঝে, আমি বুঝাইতে নারি ॥ ৩৩ ॥

prabhu kahe, vyākaraṇa paḍāi — abhimāna kari
the Lord says, grammar I teach — so I fancy
śiṣyete nā bujhe, āmi bujhāite nāri
the students not understand, I to explain cannot

33 The Lord said, “Yes, I teach grammar — or so I like to think. But My students do not understand, and I cannot explain it to them.

কাঁহা তুমি সর্ব্বশাস্ত্রে কবিত্বে প্রবীণ ।
কাঁহা আমি সবে শিশু — পড়ুয়া নবীন ॥ ৩৪ ॥

kāṁhā tumi sarva-śāstre kavitve pravīṇa
where you, in all the śāstras in poetry expert
kāṁhā āmi sabe śiśu — paḍuyā navīna
where I, merely a child — a student new

34 “How far above Me you are! You are expert in every śāstra and in poetry, while I am only a child, a new student.

তোমার কবিত্ব কিছু শুনিতে হয় মন ।
কৃপা করি’ কর যদি গঙ্গার বর্ণন ॥ ৩৫ ॥

tomāra kavitva kichu śunite haya mana
your poetry some to hear is My mind
kṛpā kari’ kara yadi gaṅgāra varṇana
mercy showing make if of the Gaṅgā a description

35 “I should like to hear some of your poetry. Be kind enough, if you will, to describe the Gaṅgā.”

*The *digvijayī* praises the Gaṅgā in a hundred verses —*

শুনিয়া ব্রাহ্মণ গর্ব্বে বর্ণিতে লাগিলা ।
ঘটী একে শত শ্লোক গঙ্গার বর্ণিলা ॥ ৩৬ ॥

śuniyā brāhmaṇa garve varṇite lāgilā
hearing this the brāhmaṇa with pride to describe began
ghaṭī eke śata śloka gaṅgāra varṇilā
in a ghaṭī one a hundred verses the Gaṅgā he described

36 Hearing this, the brāhmaṇa proudly began, and within one *ghaṭī* he described the Gaṅgā in a hundred verses.[2]

Amṛta-pravāha-bhāṣya.

"*Ghaṭī eke*": within one *ghaṭikā*[6].

The Lord praises him and shows him respect —

শুনিয়া করিল প্রভু বহুত সৎকার ।
তোমা সম পৃথিবীতে কবি নাহি আর ॥ ৩৭ ॥

śuniyā karila prabhu bahuta satkāra
hearing made the Lord great honour
tomā sama pṛthivīte kavi nāhi āra
you like in the world poet not is another

37 When He had heard them, the Lord honoured him highly: "There is no other poet in the world like you!

Amṛta-pravāha-bhāṣya.

"*Karila sat-kāra*": He showed respect.

তোমার কবিতা-শ্লোক বুঝিতে কার শক্তি ।
তুমি ভাল জান অর্থ, কিংবা সরস্বতী ॥ ৩৮ ॥

tomāra kavitā-śloka bujhite kāra śakti
your poetry the verses to understand whose power
tumi bhāla jāna artha, kiṁvā sarasvatī
you well know the meaning, or Sarasvatī

38 "Who has the power to understand your verses? You alone know their meaning well — you, or Sarasvatī.

Amṛta-pravāha-bhāṣya.

"*Kiṁbā*": that is, *kibā*, "or."

The request to explain one verse of the hymn —

এক শ্লোকের অর্থ যদি কর নিজ-মুখে ।
শুনি' সব লোক তবে পায় বড়সুখে ॥ ৩৯ ॥

eka ślokera artha yadi kara nija-mukhe
of one verse the meaning if you make with your own mouth
śuni' saba loka tabe pāya baḍa-sukhe
hearing all people then obtain with great joy

39 "If you would explain the meaning of one verse yourself, everyone here would be delighted to hear it."

*The Lord, whose memory is beyond this world (*śrutidhara*), recites one verse out of the hundred —*

তবে দিগ্বিজয়ী ব্যাখ্যার শ্লোক পুছিল ।
শত-শ্লোকের এক শ্লোক প্রভু ত' পড়িল ॥ ৪০ ॥

tabe digvijayī vyākhyāra śloka puchila
then the *digvijayī* for explanation the verse asked
śata-ślokera eka śloka prabhu ta' paḍila
of the hundred verses one verse the Lord indeed recited

40 The *digvijayī* asked which verse he should explain, and the Lord recited one of the hundred.

Amṛta-pravāha-bhāṣya.
He asked which verse he should explain.

Keśava Kāśmīrī's verse on the glory of the Gaṅgā —

মহত্ত্বং গঙ্গায়াঃ সততমিদমাভাতি নিতরাং
যদেষা শ্রীবিষ্ণোশ্চরণকমলোৎপত্তিসুভগা ।
দ্বিতীয়-শ্রীলক্ষ্মীরিব সুরনরৈরর্চ্চ্যচরণা
ভবানীভর্ত্তুর্যা শিরসি বিভবত্যদ্ভুতগুণা ॥ ৪১ ॥

mahattvaṁ gaṅgāyāḥ satatam idam ābhāti nitarāṁ
the greatness of the Gaṅgā ever this shines beyond compare
yad eṣā śrī-viṣṇoś caraṇa-kamalotpatti-subhagā
since she of Śrī Viṣṇu by birth from the lotus feet blessed
dvitīya-śrī-lakṣmīr iva sura-narair arcya-caraṇā
a second Śrī Lakṣmī like by gods and men worshipped whose feet
bhavānī-bhartur yā śirasi vibhavaty adbhuta-guṇā
of Bhavānī's husband who on the head reigns wondrous in qualities

41 "This greatness of the Gaṅgā ever shines beyond compare, for she is blessed by her birth from the lotus feet of Śrī Viṣṇu. Like a second Śrī Lakṣmī, she receives the worship of gods and men; and upon the head of Bhavānī's husband she reigns, endowed with wondrous qualities."

Amṛta-pravāha-bhāṣya.
The glory of this Gaṅgā-devī always shines, because she is supremely blessed. She was born from the lotus feet of Śrī Viṣṇu, and, like a second form of Lakṣmī-devī, she is the one whose feet gods and men worship. Endowed with wonderful qualities, she has risen above Mahādeva, the husband of Bhavānī.

Anubhāṣya.
gaṅgāyāḥ idam mahattvam satatam (always) **nitarām** (beyond doubt) **ābhāti** (shines); **yat** (because) **eṣā** (the Gaṅgā) **śrī-viṣṇoś caraṇa-kamalotpatti-subhagā** (she was born [*utpatti*, creation] from the lotus feet of Śrī Viṣṇu, that is, from the Lord's lotus feet, and by this her *bhaga*, her majesty, is beautiful; such is she), **dvitīya-śrī-lakṣmīr iva** (like a second Kamalā, endowed with beauty) **sura-naraiḥ** (by gods, men and others) **arcya-caraṇā** (she whose feet are served), **bhavānī-bhartuḥ** (of Bhavānī's *bhartā*, husband, that is, of Giriśa, Bhava) **śirasi** (on the head) **yā** (she who, the Gaṅgā) **vibhavati** (reigns); **ataḥ** (therefore) (she is) **adbhuta-guṇā** (endowed with wonderful qualities).

এই শ্লোকের অর্থ কর — প্রভু যদি কহিল ।
বিস্মিত হঞা দিগ্বিজয়ী প্রভুকে পুছিল ॥ ৪২ ॥

ei ślokera artha kara — prabhu yadi kahila
of this verse the meaning make — the Lord when said
vismita hañā digvijayī prabhuke puchila
astonished becoming the *digvijayī* the Lord asked

42 When the Lord said, “Explain this verse,” the *digvijayī* asked Him in astonishment:

*Seeing the Lord’s power of memory, the *digvijayī* is amazed and asks —*

ঝঞ্ঝাবাত-প্রায় আমি শ্লোক পড়িল ।
তার মধ্যে শ্লোক তুমি কৈছে কণ্ঠে কৈল ॥ ৪৩ ॥

jhañjhāvāta-prāya āmi śloka paḍila
a storm wind like I the verses recited
tāra madhye śloka tumi kaiche kaṇṭhe kaila
of them among a verse You how by heart learned

43 “I recited those verses like a storm wind. How could You learn one of them by heart?”

The Lord’s humble reply —

প্রভু কহে, দেবের বরে তুমি — ‘কবিবর’ ।
ঐছে দেবের বরে কেহ হয় — ‘শ্রুতিধর’ ॥ ৪৪ ॥

prabhu kahe, devera vare tumi — ‘kavi-vara’
the Lord says, of a god by the boon you — ‘the best of poets’
aiche devera vare keha haya — ‘śruti-dhara’
so of a god by the boon someone becomes — ‘one who holds all he hears’

44 The Lord said, “By the boon of a deity you are the best of poets; and by the boon of a deity another may become a *śruti-dhara*, one who holds all that he hears.”

*The *digvijayī*’s explanation —*

শ্লোকের অর্থ কৈল বিপ্র পাইয়া সন্তোষ ।
প্রভু কহে, — কহ শ্লোকের কিবা গুণ-দোষ ॥ ৪৫ ॥

ślokera artha kaila vipra pāiyā santoṣa
of the verse the meaning made the brāhmaṇa obtaining satisfaction
prabhu kahe, — kaha ślokera kibā guṇa-doṣa
the Lord says — tell of the verse what merits and faults

45 Well pleased, the brāhmaṇa explained the verse. Then the Lord said, "Tell Me, what are the merits and faults of this verse?"

At the Lord's request he declares his verse faultless and describes its merits —

বিপ্র কহে, শ্লোকে নাহি দোষের প্রকাশ ।
উপমালঙ্কার-গুণ, কিছু অনুপ্রাস ॥ ৪৬ ॥

vipra kahe, śloke nāhi doṣera prakāśa
the brāhmaṇa says, in the verse not of fault appearance
upamālaṅkāra-guṇa, kichu anuprāsa
of the ornament of simile the merit, some alliteration

46 The brāhmaṇa said, "No fault appears in it. Its merits are the ornament of simile and some alliteration."

Amṛta-pravāha-bhāṣya.
Upamā-alaṅkāra, the ornament of simile: to display a poetic excellence by giving a comparison (*upamā*). ***Anuprāsa***, alliteration: the art of sound shown in the last line by placing many *bh*'s close together.

The Lord's words and the poet's reply —

প্রভু কহেন, — কহি, যদি না করহ রোষ ।
কহ তোমার এই শ্লোকে কিবা আছে দোষ ॥ ৪৭ ॥

prabhu kahena, — kahi, yadi nā karaha roṣa
the Lord says — I shall speak, if not you become angry
kaha tomāra ei śloke kibā āche doṣa
tell your in this verse what there is fault

47 The Lord said, "May I say something, if you will not be angry? Tell Me what faults there are in this verse of yours.

The Lord praises him and asks him to examine the merits and faults of the verse —

প্রতিভার বাক্য তোমার দেবতা সন্তোষে ।
ভালমতে বিচারিলে জানি' গুণ-দোষে ॥ ৪৮ ॥

pratibhāra vākya tomāra devatā santoṣe
of genius the words your the gods please
bhāla-mate vicārile jāni' guṇa-doṣe
well if examined are known merits and faults

48 "Your words, full of genius, please even the gods; yet if they are examined well, both merits and faults come to light.

Amṛta-pravāha-bhāṣya.
The mental power to arrange speech in ever new ways is called *pratibhā*, poetic genius. By showing such a mind in this verse you have pleased even the gods; that is, your genius is richly displayed in these words. But if the verse is examined well, both its merits and its faults will come to light.

তাতে ভাল করি' শ্লোক করহ বিচার ।
কবি কহে, — যে কহিলে সেই বেদসার ॥ ৪৯ ॥

tāte bhāla kari' śloka karaha vicāra
therefore well doing the verse make examination
kavi kahe, — ye kahile sei veda-sāra
the poet says — what You recited that the essence of the Veda

49 "So let us examine the verse carefully." The poet replied, "The verse You have recited is the very essence of the Vedas.

*Thinking the Lord ignorant of the taste of poetry, the *digvijayī* mocks Him —*

বৈয়াকরণ তুমি, নাহি পড় অলঙ্কার ।
তুমি কি জানিবে এই কবিত্বের সার ॥ ৫০ ॥

vaiyākaraṇa tumi, nāhi paḍa alaṅkāra
a grammarian You, not have studied poetics
tumi ki jānibe ei kavitvera sāra
You what will know of this poetry the essence

50 "You are only a grammarian; You have not studied poetics. What can You know of the essence of this poetry?"

Amṛta-pravāha-bhāṣya.
"*Vaiyākaraṇa*": that is, a grammarian, expert (only) in the learning meant for children and unable to examine poetics (*alaṅkāra*) and other *śāstras*.

The Lord's words —

প্রভু কহেন, — অতএব পুছিয়ে তোমারে ।
বিচারিয়া গুণ-দোষ বুঝাহ আমারে ॥ ৫১ ॥

prabhu kahena, — ataeva puchiye tomāre
the Lord says — therefore I ask you
vicāriyā guṇa-doṣa bujhāha āmāre
examining the merits and faults explain to Me

51 The Lord said, "That is just why I ask you. Examine its merits and faults and explain them to Me.

নাহি পড়ি অলঙ্কার, করিয়াছি শ্রবণ ।
তাতে এই শ্লোকে দেখি বহু দোষ-গুণ ॥ ৫২ ॥

nāhi paḍi alaṅkāra, kariyāchi śravaṇa
not I have studied poetics, I have done hearing
tāte ei śloke dekhi bahu doṣa-guṇa
thereby in this verse I see many faults and merits

52 "I have not studied poetics, but I have heard it taught, and so I see many faults and merits in this verse."

Amṛta-pravāha-bhāṣya.
"I have not studied poetics, but I have heard about it from the lips of paṇḍitas. That is why I see many faults and merits in this verse."

At the poet's request the Lord examines the merits and faults of the verse —

কবি কহে, — কহ দেখি, কোন্ গুণ-দোষ ।
প্রভু কহেন, — কহি, শুন, না করিহ রোষ ॥ ৫৩ ॥

kavi kahe, — kaha dekhi, kon guṇa-doṣa
the poet says — tell, let us see, which merits and faults
prabhu kahena, — kahi, śuna, nā kariha roṣa
the Lord says — I tell, listen, not become angry

53 "Come, then," said the poet, "tell me — what merits and faults?" The Lord replied, "I shall tell you; listen, and do not be angry.

Five faults and five merits —

পঞ্চ দোষ এই শ্লোকে পঞ্চ অলঙ্কার ।
ক্রমে আমি কহি, শুন, করহ বিচার ॥ ৫৪ ॥

pañca doṣa ei śloke pañca alaṅkāra
five faults in this verse, five ornaments
krame āmi kahi, śuna, karaha vicāra
in order I tell, listen, make judgement

54 "In this verse there are five faults and five ornaments. I shall name them in order; listen, and judge for yourself.

The five faults of the verse. The first fault explained —

'অবিমৃষ্ট-বিধেয়াংশ' — দুই ঠাঞি চিহ্ন ।
'বিরুদ্ধমতি', ভগ্নক্রম', 'পুনরাত্ত', দোষ তিন ॥ ৫৫ ॥

'avimṛṣṭa-vidheyāṁśa' — dui ṭhāñi cihna
'the predicate ill placed' — in two places the mark
'viruddha-mati', bhagna-krama', 'punar-ātta', doṣa tina
'the contradictory sense', 'the broken order', 'the resumed sentence', faults three

55 "In two places the predicate is badly placed, and there are three more faults: a contradictory sense, a broken order, and a return to a finished

sentence.[3]

‘গঙ্গার মহত্ত্ব’ — শ্লোকে মূল ‘বিধেয়’ ।
ইদং শব্দে ‘অনুবাদ’ — পাছে অভিধেয় ॥ ৫৬ ॥

‘gaṅgāra mahattva’ — śloke mūla ‘vidheya’
‘of the Gaṅgā the greatness’ — in the verse the main ‘predicate’
idaṁ śabde ‘anuvāda’ — pāche abhidheya
by the word ‘idam’ the ‘subject’ — afterwards is expressed

56 “In this verse the main predicate is ‘the greatness of the Gaṅgā’, while the subject, expressed by the word *idam*, ‘this’, comes after it.[4]

‘বিধেয়’ আগে কহি’ পাছে কহিলা ‘অনুবাদ’ ।
এই লাগি’ শ্লোকের অর্থ করিয়াছে বাদ ॥ ৫৭ ॥

‘vidheya’ āge kahi’ pāche kahilā ‘anuvāda’
the ‘predicate’ first having said, afterwards you said the ‘subject’
ei lāgi’ ślokera artha kariyāche vāda
for this reason of the verse the meaning has become lost

57 “You stated the predicate first and the subject afterwards, and so the meaning of the verse has suffered.

অনুবাদমনুক্ত্বৈব ন বিধেয়মুদীরয়েৎ ।
ন হ্যলব্ধাস্পদং কিঞ্চিৎ কুত্রচিৎ প্রতিতিষ্ঠতি ॥ ৫৮ ॥

anuvādam anuktvaiva
the subject not having stated indeed
na vidheyam udīrayet
not the predicate one should utter
na hy alabdhāspadaṁ kiñcit
not indeed without a footing anything
kutracit pratitiṣṭhati
anywhere stands

58 ‘One should not state the predicate without first stating the subject; for nothing that has not found its footing can stand anywhere.’ (Ekādaśī-tattva, 13)[5]

Anubhāṣya.
See Ādi 2.74.

The second fault explained —

‘দ্বিতীয়-শ্রীলক্ষ্মী’ — ইঁহা ‘দ্বিতীয়ত্ব’ বিধেয় ।
সমাসে গৌণ হৈল, শব্দার্থ গেল ক্ষয় ॥ ৫৯ ॥

‘dvitīya-śrī-lakṣmī’ — iṁhā ‘dvitīyatva’ vidheya
‘a second Śrī Lakṣmī’ — here ‘being second’ the predicate
samāse gauṇa haila, śabdārtha gela kṣaya
in the compound subordinate it became, the word’s meaning went to ruin

59 “In *dvitīya-śrī-lakṣmī*, ‘a second Śrī Lakṣmī’, the predicate is ‘being second’; but in the compound it has become secondary, and the meaning of the word is lost.

‘দ্বিতীয়’ শব্দ — বিধেয়, তাহা পড়িল সমাসে ।
‘লক্ষ্মীর সমতা’ অর্থ করিল বিনাশে ॥ ৬০ ॥

‘dvitīya’ śabda — vidheya, tāhā paḍila samāse
‘second’ the word — the predicate, it fell into the compound
‘lakṣmīra samatā’ artha karila vināśe
‘equality with Lakṣmī’ the meaning it made destroyed

60 “The word *dvitīya* is the predicate, but it has fallen into a compound, and so the point — that the Gaṅgā is equal to Lakṣmī — is destroyed.

‘অবিমৃষ্ট-বিধেয়াংশ’ — এই দোষ নাম ।
আর এক দোষ আগে, শুন সাবধান ॥ ৬১ ॥

‘avimṛṣṭa-vidheyāṁśa’ — ei doṣa nāma
‘avimṛṣṭa-vidheyāṁśa’ — this fault’s name
āra eka doṣa āge, śuna sāvadhāna
another one fault next, listen attentively

61 “This fault is called *avimṛṣṭa-vidheyāṁśa*. Now listen attentively to another.

The third fault explained —

‘ভবানীভর্ত্তুঃ’ শব্দ দিলে পাইয়া সন্তোষ ।
‘বিরুদ্ধমতি’-কৃৎ নাম এই মহা দোষ ॥ ৬২ ॥

‘bhavānī-bhartuḥ’ śabda dile pāiyā santoṣa
‘of Bhavānī’s husband’ the word you placed gaining satisfaction
‘viruddha-mati’-kṛt nāma ei mahā doṣa
‘viruddha-mati-kṛt’ the name of this great fault

62 “With great satisfaction you used the words *bhavānī-bhartuḥ*, ‘of Bhavānī’s husband’. But this is a grave fault, called *viruddha-mati-kṛt*: such words suggest a contradictory sense.

ভবানী-শব্দে কহে মহাদেবের গৃহিণী ।
তাঁর ভর্ত্তা কহিলা দ্বিতীয় ভর্ত্তা জানি’ ॥ ৬৩ ॥

bhavānī-śabde kahe mahādevera gṛhiṇī
by the word Bhavānī is meant of Mahādeva the wife
tāṁra bhartā kahilā dvitīya bhartā jāni’
her husband you named — a second husband is understood

63 “The word *Bhavānī* means the wife of Mahādeva. When you name her husband, it sounds as if she had another husband.

‘শিবপত্নীর ভর্ত্তা — ইহা শুনিতে বিরুদ্ধ ।
‘বিরুদ্ধমতিকৃৎ’-শব্দ শাস্ত্রে নহে শুদ্ধ ॥ ৬৪ ॥

‘śiva-patnīra bhartā — ihā śunite viruddha
‘of Śiva’s wife the husband’ — this to hear contradictory
‘viruddha-mati-kṛt’-śabda śāstre nahe śuddha
a ‘viruddha-mati-kṛt’ word in the śāstra is not correct

64 “‘The husband of Śiva’s wife’ sounds absurd; by the rules of the śāstra, words that suggest a contradictory sense are faulty.

Another example of the same —

‘ব্রাহ্মণ-পত্নীর ভর্ত্তা-হস্তে দেহ দান’ ।
শব্দ শুনিতেই হয় দ্বিতীয়ভর্ত্তা জ্ঞান ॥ ৬৫ ॥

‘brāhmaṇa-patnīra bhartā-haste deha dāna’
‘of the brāhmaṇa’s wife into the husband’s hand give the gift’
śabda śunitei haya dvitīya-bhartā jñāna
the words on hearing arises of a second husband the idea

65 “If one says, ‘Give the gift into the hand of the brāhmaṇa’s wife’s husband,’ the very words make one think of a second husband.

The fourth fault explained —

‘বিভবতি’ ক্রিয়ায় বাক্য — সাঙ্গ, পুনঃ বিশেষণ ।
‘অদ্ভুতগুণা’ — এই পুনরাত্ত দূষণ ॥ ৬৬ ॥

‘vibhavati’ kriyāya vākya — sāṅga, punaḥ viśeṣaṇa
with the verb ‘vibhavati’ the sentence — complete, again an epithet
‘adbhuta-guṇā’ — ei punar-ātta dūṣaṇa
‘adbhuta-guṇā’ — this the fault of resuming

66 “The sentence is complete with the verb *vibhavati*, ‘reigns’, and then you add another epithet, *adbhuta-guṇā*, ‘endowed with wondrous qualities’. This return to a finished sentence is the fault called *punar-ātta*.

The fifth fault explained[8] —

তিন পাদে অনুপ্রাস দেখি অনুপম ।
এক পাদে নাহি, এই দোষ 'ভগ্নক্রম' ॥ ৬৭ ॥

tina pāde anuprāsa dekhi anupama
in three lines alliteration I see matchless
eka pāde nāhi, ei doṣa 'bhagna-krama'
in one line not, this fault 'bhagna-krama'

67 "In three lines I see matchless alliteration, but in one line there is none; this fault is called *bhagna-krama*.

The five faults ruin the glory of the verse —

যদ্যপি এই শ্লোকে আছে পঞ্চ অলঙ্কার ।
এই পঞ্চদোষে শ্লোক কৈল ছারখার ॥ ৬৮ ॥

yadyapi ei śloke āche pañca alaṅkāra
although in this verse there are five ornaments
ei pañca-doṣe śloka kaila chārakhāra
by these five faults the verse is made ruined

68 "Though the verse has five ornaments, these five faults have ruined it.

দশ অলঙ্কারে যদি এক শ্লোক হয় ।
এক দোষে সব অলঙ্কার হয় ক্ষয় ॥ ৬৯ ॥

daśa alaṅkāre yadi eka śloka haya
ten with ornaments if one verse is
eka doṣe saba alaṅkāra haya kṣaya
by one fault all the ornaments become lost

69 "Even if a verse had ten ornaments, a single fault would bring them all to nothing.

A comparison —

সুন্দর শরীর যৈছে ভূষণে ভূষিত ।
এক শ্বেতকুষ্ঠে যৈছে করয়ে বিগীত ॥ ৭০ ॥

sundara śarīra yaiche bhūṣaṇe bhūṣita
a beautiful body as with jewels adorned
eka śveta-kuṣṭhe yaiche karaye vigīta
one spot of white leprosy as makes disgraced

70 "It is like a beautiful body adorned with jewels: one spot of white leprosy disgraces it.

Anubhāṣya.
Vigīta: condemned.

রসালঙ্কারবৎ কাব্যং দোষযুক্ চেদ্বিভূষিতম্ ।
স্যাদ্বপুঃ সুন্দরমপি শ্বিত্রেণৈকেন দুর্ভগম্ ॥ ৭১ ॥

rasālaṅkāra-vat kāvyaṁ
with rasa and ornaments poetry
doṣa-yuk ced vibhūṣitam
with a fault if, adorned
syād vapuḥ sundaram api
becomes a body beautiful though
śvitreṇaikena durbhagam
by white leprosy by one unsightly

71 'As a body, though beautiful and adorned, is made unsightly by a single spot of white leprosy, so poetry rich in rasa and ornaments loses all its charm if it has a fault.' (Bharata Muni)

Amṛta-pravāha-bhāṣya.
A beautiful, adorned body becomes unsightly when it has a patch of white leprosy (*śvitra*). In the same way poetry endowed with rasa and ornaments becomes unsightly if it has a fault.

Anubhāṣya.

vibhūṣitam (fully adorned) **sundaram** (charming) **api vapuḥ** (body) **yathā ekena śvitreṇa** (by the disease called white leprosy) **durbhagam** (bereft of beauty, sullied) **syāt**, **tathā rasālaṅkāra-vat kāvyam** (*rasa*: *śṛṅgāra* and the rest; *alaṅkāra*: *anuprāsa*, *upamā* and the rest; *kāvya* endowed with them, speech whose soul is *rasa*) **cet** (if) **doṣa-yuk bhavati**, **tathā durbhagam** (bereft of beauty) **jñeyam**.

The five merits of the verse —

পঞ্চ অলঙ্কারের এবে শুনহ বিচার ।
দুই শব্দালঙ্কার, তিন অর্থ-অলঙ্কার ॥ ৭২ ॥

pañca alaṅkārera ebe śunaha vicāra
of the five ornaments now hear the analysis
dui śabdālaṅkāra, tina artha-alaṅkāra
two verbal ornaments, three ornaments of meaning

72 "Now hear the analysis of the five ornaments: two are verbal ornaments and three are ornaments of meaning.

The first and second merits, both ornaments of sound —

শব্দালঙ্কার — তিনপাদে আছে অনুপ্রাস ।
'শ্রীলক্ষ্মী' শব্দে 'পুনরুক্তবদাভাস' ॥ ৭৩ ॥

śabdālaṅkāra — tina-pāde āche anuprāsa
verbal ornament — in three lines there is alliteration
'śrī-lakṣmī' śabde 'punar-uktavad-ābhāsa'
in the words 'śrī-lakṣmī' 'the seeming repetition'

73 "The first verbal ornament is the alliteration in three lines; the second is the seeming repetition (*punar-uktavad-ābhāsa*) in the words *śrī-lakṣmī*.

প্রথম-চরণে পঞ্চ 'ত'-কারের পাঁতি ।
তৃতীয়-চরণে হয় পঞ্চ 'রেফ'-স্থিতি ॥ ৭৪ ॥

prathama-caraṇe pañca ‘ta’-kārera pāṁti
in the first line five ‘ta’-sounds a row
tṛtīya-caraṇe haya pañca ‘repha’-sthiti
in the third line are five ‘ra’-sounds placed

74 “In the first line there is a row of five *ta*s, and in the third, five *ra*s.

চতুর্থ-চরণে চারি ‘ভ’-কার-প্রকাশ ।
অতএব শব্দালঙ্কার অনুপ্রাস ॥ ৭৫ ॥

caturtha-caraṇe cāri ‘bha’-kāra-prakāśa
in the fourth line four ‘bha’-sounds appear
ataeva śabdālaṅkāra anuprāsa
therefore the verbal ornament alliteration

75 “In the fourth line four *bha*s appear; this is the verbal ornament of alliteration.

‘শ্রী’-শব্দে, ‘লক্ষ্মী’-শব্দে — এক বস্তু উক্ত ।
পুনরুক্তপ্রায় ভাসে, নহে পুনরুক্ত ॥ ৭৬ ॥

‘śrī’-śabde, ‘lakṣmī’-śabde — eka vastu ukta
by the word ‘śrī’, by the word ‘lakṣmī’ — one thing is said
punar-ukta-prāya bhāse, nahe punar-ukta
a repetition almost it seems, is not a repetition

76 “The words *śrī* and *lakṣmī* name one and the same thing; it seems almost a repetition, yet it is not one.

‘শ্রীযুক্ত লক্ষ্মী’ অর্থে অর্থের বিভেদ ।
পুনরুক্তবদাভাস, শব্দালঙ্কার-ভেদ ॥ ৭৭ ॥

‘śrī-yukta lakṣmī’ arthe arthera vibheda
‘Lakṣmī endowed with śrī’ in the sense of the meanings a difference
punar-uktavad-ābhāsa, śabdālaṅkāra-bheda
seeming repetition, of verbal ornament a kind

77 “For if *śrī-lakṣmī* is taken as ‘Lakṣmī endowed with beauty (*śrī*)’, the two words differ in meaning; and this seeming repetition is a kind of verbal ornament.

The third, fourth and fifth merits, all three ornaments of sense —

‘লক্ষ্মীরিব’ অর্থালঙ্কার — উপমা-প্রকাশ ।
আর অর্থালঙ্কার আছে, নাম — ‘বিরোধাভাস’ ॥ ৭৮ ॥

‘lakṣmīr iva’ arthālaṅkāra — upamā-prakāśa
‘lakṣmīr iva’ ornament of meaning — of simile the appearance
āra arthālaṅkāra āche, nāma — ‘virodhābhāsa’
another ornament of meaning there is, its name — ‘virodhābhāsa’

78 “The words *lakṣmīr iva*, ‘like Lakṣmī’, are an ornament of meaning: a simile. There is another ornament of meaning, called *virodhābhāsa*, apparent contradiction.

‘গঙ্গাতে কমল জন্মে’ — সবার সুবোধ ।
‘কমলে গঙ্গার জন্ম’ — অত্যন্ত বিরোধ ॥ ৭৯ ॥

‘gaṅgāte kamala janme’ — sabāra subodha
‘in the Gaṅgā the lotus is born’ — everyone’s ready understanding
‘kamale gaṅgāra janma’ — atyanta virodha
‘in the lotus of the Gaṅgā the birth’ — utter contradiction

79 “Everyone knows that lotuses are born in the Gaṅgā; but to say that the Gaṅgā is born in a lotus is a flat contradiction.

‘ইঁহা বিষ্ণুপাদপদ্মে গঙ্গার উৎপত্তি’ ।
বিরোধালঙ্কার ইহার মহা-চমৎকৃতি ॥ ৮০ ॥

‘iṁhā viṣṇu-pāda-padme gaṅgāra utpatti’
‘here in Viṣṇu’s lotus feet of the Gaṅgā the origin’
virodhālaṅkāra ihāra mahā-camatkṛti
the ornament of contradiction of this great wonder

80 "Yet here the Gaṅgā has her origin in the lotus feet of Viṣṇu, and this ornament of contradiction is wonderful indeed.

ঈশ্বর-অচিন্ত্যশক্ত্যে গঙ্গার প্রকাশ ।
ইহাতে বিরোধ নাহি, বিরোধ-আভাস ॥ ৮১ ॥

īśvara-acintya-śaktye gaṅgāra prakāśa
by the Lord's inconceivable potency of the Gaṅgā the appearance
ihāte virodha nāhi, virodha-ābhāsa
in this contradiction not, of contradiction the semblance

81 "The Gaṅgā appears by the inconceivable potency of the Lord, so there is no contradiction here — only the semblance of one.

Evidence of Kṛṣṇa's inconceivable energy (a verse spoken by the Lord Śrī Kṛṣṇa Caitanya Himself) —

অম্বুজমম্বুনি জাতং ক্বচিদপি ন জাতমম্বুজাদম্বু ।
মুরভিদি তদ্বিপরীতং পাদাম্ভোজান্মহানদী জাতা ॥ ৮২ ॥

ambujam ambuni jātaṁ kvacid
the lotus in water born anywhere
api na jātam ambujād ambu
even not born from a lotus water
mura-bhidi tad-viparītaṁ
in the slayer of Mura the reverse
pādāmbhojān mahā-nadī jātā
from His lotus feet the great river was born

82 'The lotus is born in water; nowhere is water born from a lotus. But with the slayer of Mura it is the reverse: from His lotus feet the great river was born.'

Amṛta-pravāha-bhāṣya.
A lotus is born only in water; water is never born from a lotus. But here is the wonder: in Śrī Kṛṣṇa the opposite is seen — from His lotus feet the great river Gaṅgā was born.

Anubhāṣya.

ambuni (in water) **ambujam** (the lotus) **jātam** (is born); **kvacit** (anywhere) **api ambujāt** (from a lotus) **ambu** (water) **na jātam**; (but) **mura-bhidi** (in Murāri, Kṛṣṇa) **tad-viparītam** (the opposite, the reversal of the [usual] relation of cause and effect) (is seen), **yataḥ** (from Kṛṣṇa's lotus feet) **mahā-nadī** (the Gaṅgā) **jātā** (flowed forth).

গঙ্গার মহত্ত্ব — সাধ্য, সাধন তাহার ।
বিষ্ণুপাদোৎপত্তি — 'অনুমান' অলঙ্কার ॥ ৮৩ ॥

gaṅgāra mahattva — sādhya, sādhana tāhāra
of the Gaṅgā the greatness — what is to be proved, the proof of it
viṣṇu-pādotpatti — 'anumāna' alaṅkāra
the birth from Viṣṇu's feet — 'anumāna' ornament

83 "The greatness of the Gaṅgā is what is to be proved, and the proof of it is her birth from the feet of Viṣṇu; this is the ornament called *anumāna*, inference.

স্থূল এই পঞ্চ দোষ, পঞ্চ অলঙ্কার ।
সূক্ষ্ম বিচারিয়ে যদি আছয়ে অপার ॥ ৮৪ ॥

sthūla ei pañca doṣa, pañca alaṅkāra
obvious these five faults, five ornaments
sūkṣma vicāriye yadi āchaye apāra
finely if I examine there are countless

84 "These are the five obvious faults and the five ornaments; examined more finely, they would be countless.

Amṛta-pravāha-bhāṣya.

The verse "*Mahattvaṁ gaṅgāyāḥ*" has five ornaments (*alaṅkāra*), which are its merits, and five faults (*doṣa*). In two places the fault is *avimṛṣṭa-vidheyāṁśa* (the *vidheya*, the new statement, is not properly set apart), and in three more there are the faults *viruddha-mati* (creating a contradictory idea), *punarukti* (repetition) and *bhagna-krama* (broken order).

The first *avimṛṣṭa-vidheyāṁśa* fault is this. The main *vidheya* of the verse is the glory of the Gaṅgā, and the word *idam*, “this,” is the *anuvāda* (what is being spoken of, the already known). Here “the glory of the Gaṅgā” is written first and the word *idam* after it, and that is against the rules. If the *anuvāda*, the known subject, is not written first, the meaning suffers.

The second *avimṛṣṭa-vidheyāṁśa* fault is this. In the expression *dvitīya-śrī-lakṣmīr iva*, “like a second Śrī Lakṣmī,” the *vidheya*, the unknown, is “secondness” (*dvitīyatva*). It was placed first and made part of a compound (*samāsa*), and so the meaning became subordinate and was lost. For the point of the meaning was to show [the Gaṅgā’s] equality with Lakṣmī, and the faulty compound destroyed it.

The third fault, *viruddha-mati-kṛt*, is seen in the word *bhavānī-bhartuḥ*, “of Bhavānī’s husband.” In such usage the word *Bhavānī* means Mahādeva’s wife, and the word *bhavānī-bhartā* gives rise to another idea, that of a second husband of Bhavānī. Such words taint poetry with the fault *viruddha-mati-kṛt*.

The fourth fault is this. The sentence ended with the verb *vibhavati*, “reigns,” and after it the epithet *adbhuta-guṇā*, “endowed with wonderful qualities,” is given. This is the fault *punar-ātta* (returning to a finished sentence).

The fifth fault is *bhagna-krama*. Three lines, the first, third and fourth, have alliteration on *t*, *r* and *bh*, but the second line has none. That is the fault *bhagna-krama*.

The verse has five ornaments and merits, yet these five faults have ruined it. If a verse has ten ornaments and even one fault, it is condemned (*vigīta*), like a beautiful body adorned with ornaments but marked by a white patch of leprosy.

Now I will speak of the merits. This verse of yours has two ornaments of sound (*śabdālaṅkāra*) and three ornaments of sense (*arthālaṅkāra*). (1) The alliteration in three lines is an ornament of sound. (2) The expression “Śrī Lakṣmī” is not the fault of repetition (*punarukti*): it is the ornament of sound *punarukta-vad-ābhāsa*, apparent repetition. If “Śrī” and “Lakṣmī” are taken as one and the same, there is no fault at all. If the sense is taken as “Lakṣmī endowed with beauty (*śrī*),” the meanings do differ, and there is no repetition: it is a special ornament of sound, *punarukta-vad-ābhāsa*. (3) The expression *lakṣmīr iva*, “like Lakṣmī,” is an ornament of sense, the simile (*upamālaṅkāra*). (4) There is one more ornament of sense, *virodhābhāsa*, apparent contradiction, in what is said of the Gaṅgā’s birth from Viṣṇu’s lotus feet. A lotus is born from water, but here water

is born from a lotus; such contradictory words give rise to the ornament of contradiction (*virodha*). But the Gaṅgā appeared by the inconceivable energy of the Lord, so there is no contradiction here at all, only an "apparent contradiction," and that is the ornament. (5) The words that prove the *sādhya*, the glory of the Gaṅgā, that is, the words about her birth from Viṣṇu's feet, are the ornament *anumāna*, inference.

The Lord, who sees no faults in others, encourages the poet —

প্রতিভা, কবিত্ব তোমার দেবতা-প্রসাদে ।
অবিচার কাব্যে অবশ্য পড়ে দোষ-বাধে ॥ ৮৫ ॥

pratibhā, kavitva tomāra devatā-prasāde
genius, poetic gift your by a deity's grace
avicāra kāvye avaśya paḍe doṣa-bādhe
in poetry without reflection surely fall faults as obstacles

85 "Your genius and your poetic gift come by the grace of a deity; but into poetry composed without reflection faults are bound to creep.

Anubhāṣya.

If poetry is not examined, its faults are certainly not easy to see[9].

বিচার করিলে কবিত্ব হয় সুনির্ম্মল ।
সালঙ্কার হৈলে অর্থ করে ঝলমল ॥ ৮৬ ॥

vicāra karile kavitva haya sunirmala
reflection if one makes, poetry becomes spotless
sālaṅkāra haile artha kare jhalamala
with ornaments if it is, the meaning makes a glitter

86 "With reflection, poetry becomes flawless, and when it is adorned with ornaments, its meaning sparkles."

*Amazed, the *digvijayī* reflects —*

শুনিয়া প্রভুর বাক্য দিগ্বিজয়ী বিস্মিত ।
মুখে না নিঃসরে বাক্য, প্রতিভা — স্তম্ভিত ॥ ৮৭ ॥

śuniyā prabhura vākya digvijayī vismita
hearing of the Lord the words the *digvijayī* astonished
mukhe nā niḥsare vākya, pratibhā — stambhita
from his mouth not came forth a word, his genius — stunned

87 Hearing the Lord's words, the *digvijayī* was astonished. No word came from his mouth; his genius was struck dumb.

কহিতে চাহয়ে কিছু, না আইসে উত্তর ।
তবে বিচারয়ে মনে হইয়া ফাঁপর ॥ ৮৮ ॥

kahite cāhaye kichu, nā āise uttara
to say he wishes something, not comes an answer
tabe vicāraye mane haiyā phāṁpara
then he reflects in his mind becoming perplexed

88 He wanted to say something, but no answer would come, and in his perplexity he thought:

পড়ুয়া বালক কৈল মোর বুদ্ধি-লোপ ।
জানি, সরস্বতী মোরে করিয়াছেন কোপ ॥ ৮৯ ॥

paḍuyā bālaka kaila mora buddhi-lopa
a student boy made my intelligence lost
jāni, sarasvatī more kariyāchena kopa
I know, Sarasvatī with me has become angry

89 "A schoolboy has robbed me of my wits! Surely Sarasvatī is angry with me.

He concludes that the goddess of speech gave the Lord's extraordinary

explanation —

যে ব্যাখ্যা করিল, সে মনুষ্যের নহে শক্তি ।
নিমাঞি-মুখে রহি' বলে আপনে সরস্বতী ॥ ৯০ ॥

ye vyākhyā karila, se manuṣyera nahe śakti
what explanation He made, that of a man is not the power
nimāñi-mukhe rahi' bale āpane sarasvatī
in Nimāi's mouth dwelling speaks herself Sarasvatī

90 "No human being could give such an explanation. Sarasvatī herself must be speaking through Nimāi's mouth."

The poet's words to the Lord —

এত ভাবি' কহে — শুন, নিমাঞি পণ্ডিত ।
তব ব্যাখ্যা শুনি' আমি হইলাঙ বিস্মিত ॥ ৯১ ॥

eta bhāvi' kahe — śuna, nimāñi paṇḍita
so much thinking he says — listen, Nimāi Paṇḍita
tava vyākhyā śuni' āmi hailāṅa vismita
Your explanation hearing I have become astonished

91 Thinking thus, he said, "Listen, Nimāi Paṇḍita: Your explanation has astonished me.

অলঙ্কার নাহি পড়, নাহি শাস্ত্রাভ্যাস ।
কেমনে এ সব অর্থ করিলে প্রকাশ ॥ ৯২ ॥

alaṅkāra nāhi paḍa, nāhi śāstrābhyāsa
poetics not You have studied, no practice in the śāstras
kemane e saba artha karile prakāśa
how these all meanings have You brought out

92 "You have not studied poetics, and You have no training in the śāstras. How could You bring out all these meanings?"

ইহা শুনি' মহাপ্রভু অতি বড় রঙ্গী ।
তাঁহার হৃদয় জানি' কহে, করি' ভঙ্গী ॥ ৯৩ ॥

ihā śuni' mahāprabhu ati baḍa raṅgī
this hearing Mahāprabhu, very great lover of fun
tāṁhāra hṛdaya jāni' kahe, kari' bhaṅgī
his heart knowing says, making a playful turn

93 Hearing this, Mahāprabhu, who dearly loved a jest, read his heart and answered playfully:

The Lord names Sarasvatī as the cause of His skilful explanation —

শাস্ত্রের বিচার ভাল-মন্দ নাহি জানি ।
সরস্বতী যে বলায়, সেই বলি বাণী ॥ ৯৪ ॥

śāstrera vicāra bhāla-manda nāhi jāni
of the śāstras the analysis good or bad not I know
sarasvatī ye balāya, sei bali vāṇī
Sarasvatī what makes Me say, those I speak words

94 "Whether My analysis of the śāstras is good or bad, I Myself do not know. I only speak the words that Sarasvatī makes Me speak."

*The *digvijayī* feels hurt by Sarasvatī —*

ইহা শুনি' দিগ্বিজয়ী করিল নিশ্চয় ।
শিশুদ্বারে দেবী মোরে কৈল পরাজয় ॥ ৯৫ ॥

ihā śuni' digvijayī karila niścaya
this hearing the *digvijayī* made conclusion
śiśu-dvāre devī more kaila parājaya
through a child the goddess on me inflicted defeat

95 Hearing this, the *digvijayī* concluded, "The goddess has defeated me through a child.

আজি তাঁরে নিবেদিব, করি' জপ-ধ্যান ।
শিশুদ্বারে কৈল মোরে এত অপমান ॥ ৯৬ ॥

āji tāṁre nivediba, kari' japa-dhyāna
today to her I shall submit, doing japa and meditation
śiśudvāre kaila more eta apamāna
through a child she inflicted on me such humiliation

96 "Today, with japa and meditation, I shall lay this before her: through a child she has humiliated me so!"

The author points out the real cause of what happened —

বস্তুতঃ সরস্বতী অশুদ্ধ শ্লোক করাইল ।
বিচার-সময় তাঁর বুদ্ধি আচ্ছাদিল ॥ ৯৭ ॥

vastutaḥ sarasvatī aśuddha śloka karāila
in truth Sarasvatī a faulty verse had him make
vicāra-samaya tāṁra buddhi ācchādila
at the time of examination his intelligence covered

97 In truth, it was Sarasvatī who had him compose a faulty verse, and when it was examined she clouded his intelligence.

The students laugh at the poet's defeat, and the Lord stops them —

তবে শিষ্যগণ সব হাসিতে লাগিল ।
তা'-সবা নিষেধি' প্রভু কবিকে কহিল ॥ ৯৮ ॥

tabe śiṣya-gaṇa saba hāsite lāgila
then the students all to laugh began
tā'-sabā niṣedhi' prabhu kavike kahila
them all forbidding the Lord to the poet spoke

98 Then all the students began to laugh, but the Lord checked them and said to the poet:

The Lord honours the poet —

তুমি মহাপণ্ডিত হও, কবি-শিরোমণি ।
যাঁর মুখে বাহিরায় ঐছে কাব্যবাণী ॥ ৯৯ ॥

tumi mahāpaṇḍita hao, kavi-śiromaṇi
you a great paṇḍita are, the crest-jewel of poets
yāṁra mukhe bāhirāya aiche kāvya-vāṇī
from whose mouth comes forth such poetic speech

99 "You are a great paṇḍita, the crest-jewel of poets, for such poetry flows from your lips.

তোমার কবিত্ব যেন গঙ্গাজল-ধার ।
তোমা-সম কবি কোথা নাহি দেখি আর ॥ ১০০ ॥

tomāra kavitva yena gaṅgā-jala-dhāra
your poetry like of the Gaṅgā's water the stream
tomā-sama kavi kothā nāhi dekhi āra
you like a poet anywhere not I see another

100 "Your poetry is like the stream of the Gaṅgā's waters; nowhere do I see another poet like you.

There are faults even in the poetry of Jayadeva, Kālidāsa and Bhavabhūti —

ভবভূতি, জয়দেব, আর কালিদাস ।
তাঁ-সবার কবিত্বে হয় দোষের প্রকাশ ॥ ১০১ ॥

bhavabhūti, jayadeva, āra kālidāsa
Bhavabhūti, Jayadeva, and Kālidāsa
tāṁ-sabāra kavitve haya doṣera prakāśa
of them all in the poetry there is of faults appearance

101 "Even in the poetry of Bhavabhūti, Jayadeva and Kālidāsa faults appear.

Anubhāṣya.

Bhavabhūti, or Śrīkaṇṭha, wrote the Sanskrit plays *Mālatī-mādhava*, *Uttara-carita*, *Vīra-carita* and others. He lived in the reign of King Bhoja. A resident of Padmanagara, he was the son of Nīlakaṇṭha and the grandson of a *śrotriya* brāhmaṇa of the Kāśyapa *gotra* named Bhaṭṭa Gopāla.

Kālidāsa was a great poet, one of the renowned "nine jewels" at the court of Emperor Vikramāditya. He wrote the *Raghu-vaṁśa*, *Kumāra-sambhava*, *Abhijñāna-śakuntala*, *Megha-dūta* and others, some thirty or forty Sanskrit epic poems, plays and works on other subjects.

Jayadeva: see Ādi 13.42.

The true merit is the very gift of composing verse —

দোষ-গুণ-বিচারে এই অল্প করি' মানি ।
কবিত্ব-করণে শক্তি তাঁহা সে বাখানি ॥ ১০২ ॥

doṣa-guṇa-vicāre ei alpa kari' māni
in the analysis of faults and merits this little making I consider
kavitva-karaṇe śakti tāṁhā se vākhāni
in making poetry the power of theirs that I praise

102 "I count such analysis of faults and merits a small thing; what I praise is their power to compose poetry.

The Lord's humble words —

শৈশব-চাপল্য কিছু না লবে আমার ।
শিষ্যের সমান মুঞি না হঙ তোমার ॥ ১০৩ ॥

śaiśava-cāpalya kichu nā labe āmāra
childish restlessness any not you take of Mine
śiṣyera samāna muñi nā haṅa tomāra
of a student equal I not am of yours

103 "Do not take My childish pranks to heart. I am not even fit to be your student.

The Lord courteously takes leave of him —

আজি' বাসা যাহ, কালি মিলন আবার ।
শুনিব তোমার মুখে শাস্ত্রের বিচার ॥ ১০৪ ॥

āji' vāsā yāha, kāli milana ābāra
today to your lodging go, tomorrow meeting again
śuniba tomāra mukhe śāstrera vicāra
I shall hear from your mouth of the śāstras the exposition

104 "Go to your lodging today; tomorrow we shall meet again, and I shall hear you expound the śāstras."

At night the poet worships Sarasvatī —

এইমতে নিজ-ঘরে গেলা দুই জন ।
কবি রাত্রে কৈল সরস্বতী-আরাধন ॥ ১০৫ ॥

eimate nija-ghare gelā dui jana
in this way to their own homes went the two persons
kavi rātre kaila sarasvatī-ārādhana
the poet at night made of Sarasvatī worship

105 So the two went home, and that night the poet worshipped Sarasvatī.

Instructed by Sarasvatī, he recognises the Lord as the Supreme Lord Himself —

সরস্বতী রাত্রে তাঁরে উপদেশ কৈল ।
সাক্ষাৎ ঈশ্বর করি' প্রভুরে জানিল ॥ ১০৬ ॥

sarasvatī rātre tāṁre upadeśa kaila
Sarasvatī at night him instruction gave
sākṣāt īśvara kari' prabhure jānila
directly the Lord as the Lord he knew

106 In the night Sarasvatī instructed him, and he came to know that Nimāi was the Lord Himself.

In the morning he takes shelter at the Lord's feet, and the Lord bestows mercy on him —

প্রাতে আসি, প্রভুপদে লইল শরণ ।
প্রভু কৃপা কৈল, তাঁর খণ্ডিল বন্ধন ॥ ১০৭ ॥

prāte āsi, prabhu-pade laila śaraṇa
in the morning coming, at the Lord's feet took shelter
prabhu kṛpā kaila, tāṁra khaṇḍila bandhana
the Lord mercy showed, his cut bondage

107 In the morning he came and took shelter at the Lord's feet, and the Lord showed him mercy and cut his bonds.

Amṛta-pravāha-bhāṣya.
Bandhana, bondage: the bondage of māyā, that is, pride in learning.

Thus ends the sixteenth chapter of the "Amṛta-pravāha-bhāṣya."

*The *digvijayī*'s pious merit (*sukṛti*) —*

ভাগ্যবন্ত দিগ্বিজয়ী সফল-জীবন ।
বিদ্যা-বলে পাইল মহাপ্রভুর চরণ ॥ ১০৮ ॥

bhāgyavanta digvijayī saphala-jīvana
fortunate the *digvijayī* fruitful life
vidyā-bale pāila mahāprabhura caraṇa
by the power of learning obtained of Mahāprabhu the feet

108 The *digvijayī* was fortunate, and his life bore fruit: through his learning he attained the feet of Mahāprabhu.

Anubhāṣya.
Thus ends the sixteenth chapter of the "Anubhāṣya."

এসব লীলা বর্ণিয়াছেন বৃন্দাবনদাস ।
যে কিছু করিল ইঁহা, বিশেষ প্রকাশ ॥ ১০৯ ॥

esaba līlā varṇiyāchena vṛndāvanadāsa
all these pastimes has described Vṛndāvana-dāsa
ye kichu karila iṁhā, viśeṣa prakāśa
what little I have done here, a fuller presentation

109 Vṛndāvana dāsa has described all these pastimes; what little I have done here is to set out certain points more fully.

চৈতন্য-গোসাঞির লীলা — অমৃতের ধার ।
সর্ব্বেন্দ্রিয়তৃপ্তি হয় শ্রবণে যাহার ॥ ১১০ ॥

caitanya-gosāñira līlā — amṛtera dhāra
of Caitanya Gosāñi the pastimes — of nectar a stream
sarvendriya tṛpti haya śravaṇe yāhāra
of all the senses satisfaction comes in hearing of which

110 The pastimes of Caitanya Gosāñi are a stream of nectar: whoever hears them finds every sense fully satisfied.

শ্রীরূপ-রঘুনাথ-পদে যার আশ ।
চৈতন্যচরিতামৃত কহে কৃষ্ণদাস ॥ ১১১ ॥

śrī-rūpa-raghunātha-pade yāra āśa
Śrī Rūpa's, Raghunātha's at the feet whose hope
caitanya-caritāmṛta kahe kṛṣṇadāsa
"Caitanya-caritāmṛta" narrates Kṛṣṇadāsa

111 Praying at the feet of Śrī Rūpa and Śrī Raghunātha, I, Kṛṣṇadāsa, narrate the *Caitanya-caritāmṛta*.

Notes

1. A play on words: *nīca-gā* means both "flowing downward" and "going to the lowly". ↩
2. A *ghaṭī* (*ghaṭikā*) is a measure of time of twenty-four minutes. ↩

3. The names of the faults (*doṣa*) in the original: *avimṛṣṭa-vidheyāṁśa*, “the predicate not duly considered”, that is, what is asserted about the subject is badly placed (vv. 56–61); *viruddha-mati-kṛt*, “that which suggests a contradictory sense” (vv. 62–65); *punar-ātta*, “taken up again”: a return to a sentence already completed by its verb (v. 66); *bhagna-krama*, “broken order” (v. 67). ↩
4. *Vidheya*, the predicate, is what is asserted about a thing, the new matter for the hearer; *anuvāda*, the subject, is the thing itself, already known. ↩
5. The same verse is quoted in Ādi 2.74 (there *anuktvā tu*, here *anuktvaiva*, with the same meaning). ↩
6. A *ghaṭikā* is twenty-four minutes. ↩
7. Unclear passage: the edition reads “বর্ণি লীলাভোগ ‘লঘুকেশব’ নামেতে” (literally “having described *līlā-bhoga*, under the name ‘Laghu-Keśava’”); the meaning of *līlā-bhoga* and of the construction is unclear, and the translation is tentative. ↩
8. The edition has “পঞ্চ দোষের” (“of the five faults”), apparently for “পঞ্চম দোষের” (“of the fifth fault”). ↩
9. The verse translation reads otherwise: “into poetry composed without reflection faults are bound to creep.” ↩